



ily available, whether it's for gaming, or for graphics applications.

The cheapest CRT monitor currently available is from Krypton, whose 14-inch model (the 454LR) is available for under Rs 4,000. The most popular 15-inch CRT monitor is the Samsung 56V, which costs around Rs 5,800. This model appears to be a favourite with system integrators—largely because Samsung is a pioneer in bundling products, giving good returns in terms of value for money.

In the 17-inch CRT category, Samsung's 7535 is the choice of people looking for real value for money, with a price tag of Rs 7,100 to Rs 7,400. Other models that are pop-

ular with users include the LG 500G in the 15-inch category with a price tag of around Rs 5,800, whereas the LG 700G, with a price tag of around Rs 8,500, is a monitor of choice in the 17-inch category.

LCD monitors—a new craze among technology enthusiasts, CEOs and CTOs—have had a massive price drop of around 25 per cent over the past year. Further, LCDs are seeing a spurt in demand as many call centres set up bases in India. Hence, some major PC vendors have started bundling LCDs with their PCs, particularly Zenith, HP and HCL.

This has created more awareness among buyers. Seizing the opportunity, more vendors



Buying Tips for CRT Monitor

A monitor is an essential part of any computer system. After a bit of research, you'll be able to select a monitor with the size and image quality that suits your needs. The falling prices of CRT monitors are making larger monitors more attractive and affordable, and can reinvigorate your computing experience and keep you happy.

Dot Pitch

■ The first criterion to look for in a monitor is the 'Dot Pitch'. Every object and character on a monitor is made up of dots, and the distance between the centres of two dots is called the dot pitch. The smaller the dot pitch the closer the dots are to each other and the image on the screen will be that much sharper. Typically a dot pitch of .28 or less is good, anything above .28 will look grainy.

Screen Size

■ The monitor size is actually the size of the CRT measured diagonally from one corner to the opposite corner, but this is not the actual size of the image that you will see.

The actual viewable area will usually have

a smaller diagonal measurement. Most monitor manufacturers measure the entire glass of the CRT which extends beyond the monitor bezel (case) thus giving a false impression. For example, on some CRT monitors, a monitor sold as a 14-inch may have a viewable area of only 12.5 inches, a 15-inch may have 13.8 inches, a 17-inch may have 15.6 inches, and a 21-inch may have 19.8 inches. These figures may vary slightly from manufacturer to manufacturer.

Scan Rate

■ The scan rate is the period that a monitor takes for the electron gun to refresh the display. The electron gun inside the monitor scans each row of the display area typically a display with the resolution 1024 x 768 has 1024 pixels in a row and 768 rows. Each dot in these rows must be continuously refreshed by the electron gun as those dots (made up of phosphor) lose their charge quickly and begin to fade. The time it takes for the electron gun to refresh an entire line horizontally is called the Horizontal Refresh Rate, and this

is measured in kilohertz (KHz). The vertical scan rate is the time the monitor takes to scan the CRT from top to bottom, and is measured in hertz. The faster the scan rate, the less flicker the monitor will have.

Refresh Rate

■ This is a measure of the time it takes for the monitor to refresh the screen. It's calculated using the horizontal scan rate and the resolution of the monitor. Often the refresh rate is given in the manual provided with the monitor. You may come across the specifications 1,024 x 768 @ 75 Hz. In this case, 75 Hz is the refresh rate of the monitor. As a rule of the thumb, a refresh rate of 72 KHz or higher will produce a flicker-free display, provided your video card can produce a signal at that refresh rate.

Resolutions Supported

■ Typical resolutions include 640 x 480, 1,024 x 768, 1,280 x 1,024 and 1,600 x 1,200. Note that your video card must be able to support the higher resolutions as well. A monitor might support a resolution of 1,600 x 1,200, but the

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